[INCH-POUND]
A-A-3068/GEN
February 14,1997
SUPERSEDING
SS-S-736D
June 1, 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STONES, SHARPENING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1. Scope. This commercial item description covers abrasive stones for the sharpening of edged tools and instruments.

2. CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Classification. The sharpening stones shall be the following types, classes, styles and grades.

Type I.	Mounted-in-the-box stone.
Type II.	Unmounted stones.
Type III.	Taper Round Stones.
Type IV.	Scythe Stones.
Type V.	Knife, Sharpening Stones.
Type VI.	Grooved Surgical and Dental Stones.
Type VII.	Ax Sharpening Stones.
Type X.	Shoemakers' Stones.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any other data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Branch (7FXEE), 819 Taylor Street, Fort Worth, TX 76102.

FSC 5340

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Class A1 - Artificial (Aluminum oxide, oil-impregnated)
Class A2 - Artificial (Silicon carbide, not oil-impregnated)
Class B - Natural (Novaculite, not oil-impregnated)

Style 1 - Retangular
Style 2 - Half round
Style 3 - Round
Style 4 - Square
Style 5 - Triangular
Style 6 - Knife sharpening or knife blade
Style 7 - Point
Style 8 - Oval
Style 9 - Silversmiths' oval tapered
Style 10 - Round with beveled edge
Style 11 - Rectangular with handle
Style 12 - Reamer
Style 13 - Gouge slip
Style 14 - Round edge slip

Grade A - Extra-fine: 400 to 500 grit
Grade B - Fine: 280 to 320 grit
Grade C - Medium: 150 to 240 grit
Grade D - Coarse: 90 to 120 grit
Grade E - Extra-coarse 60 to 80 grit
Grade F - Combination of grit sizes (as specified)

Class 1 - Hard (slow-cutting)
Class 2 - Soft (medium cutting)
Class 3 - Soft (slow cutting)

3. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification slash sheets. This CID requires that individual CID slash sheets be used in conjunction with the basic requirements of this document. Type, Abrasive class, Style, Grade and hardness class shall be referenced in the contract or order (see 7.3).

3.2 Type V stones. The cylindrical shaped stones shall be made by the sodium silicate bonding method and constructed with an internal reinforcing wire or rod to resist breakage.

3.3 Class A1 and A2 artificial stones. The Class A1 and A2 stones shall be made from furnace abrasives and suitable bonding materials (vitrified process).

3.4 Class B natural stones. Class B stones shall be a superior variety of novaculite, commonly known as Arkansas stone.

Class A1 and A2. The class A1 and A2 stones shall be furnished in extra-fine, fine, medium, coarse, extra-coarse and combination grits, as specified (see 7.3). The abrasive content of the stone shall be between 65 and 85 percent. Unless otherwise specified, class A-1 shall be oil-impregnated and class A-2 shall not be oil-impregnated.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6 Combination stones. The combination shall be comprised of a coarse and fine grit that are manufactured either by the vitrified method or with a nonwater soluble, and oil resistant adhesive. A minimum of 50 percent of the stone thickness shall be coarse grit and not less than 42 percent of the stone shall be fine grit.

3.7 Class B, natural stones. Class B stones shall be furnished in hard (slow-cutting, 2.30 g./cc, minimum) and soft (medium cutting 2.0 to 2.29 g./cc), as specified (see 7.3). Class B stones shall not be oil-impregnated.

3.8 Type I stones. Type I stones shall be rectangular and finished on all sides except the bottom. The edges of the stone may be slightly chamfered to prevent chipping. The stone shall be cemented in a good commercial grade hardwood or molded metal mounting case with cover. The case shall incorporate a non-slip bottom surface.

3.9 Workmanship. Sharpening stones shall possess sufficient strength to withstand normal service without chipping, breaking, or damage. They shall also have good sharpening qualities.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

4.1 The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4.2 Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID and applicable slash sheets, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Packaging. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7. NOTES

7.1 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on the date of the invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American National Standards Institute:

ANSI B74.18 - Specifications for Grading of Certain Abrasive Grain on Coated Abrasive Products.

ANSI B74.12 - Specifications for the Size of Abrasive Grain - Grinding Wheels, Polishing and General Industrial Uses.

ANSI standards are available from the American National Standards Institute, Inc., 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.

7.2 Part Identification Number (PIN). The stones conforming to this commercial item description shall be identified by a part number configuration consisting of identification from a portion of the CID number, applicable slash sheet dash number and referenced part number with the individual slash sheet. An example of the part number configuration is shown below. This part numbering system is intended for identification and cross-indexing for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

AA3068/XX-XX

- XX-XX: Dash number as referenced in CID slash sheet.
- /XX: CID slash sheet number.
- AA3068: CID number.

7.3 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this CID and the appropriate CID slash sheet (see 6.3).
(b) Type, class, style, grade required (see 2.1, 3.1 thru 3.5)
(c) Oil-impregnation of class A-2, if required (see 3.4.1)

7.4 Specification sheets. Refer to Table I which indicates the specification sheets applicable to the various types, classes and styles.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I. Classification and dimensional tables

Specification sheet	Type	Class	Styles (shapes)
A-A-3068/1	I	B	1
A-A-3068/2	II	A1	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 9, 12, 13, 14
A-A-3068/3	II	A2	1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 14
A-A-3068/4	II	B	1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8,14
A-A-3068/5	II	A1/A2	1
		B/A1	1
A-A-3068/6	III	A1	3
A-A-3068/7	IV	A2	8
A-A-3068/8	V	A2	3, 10
A-A-3068/9	VI	B	6
A-A-3068/10	VII	A2	10, 14
A-A-3068/11	X	A2	11

Note: For the purposes of this table, grade and cutting classes may be applicable to all corresponding specification sheets.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Review activities:
Air Force - 84
Army - AV

User activity:
Navy - YD2

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.